

Eclipse of the Sun

It's a sunny day, but a shadow falls over the land. It is darker than a cloud covering the Sun: the light dims completely and for a few moments day turns to night. This is a solar eclipse.

The streaming light is the Sun's corona.

You are lucky if you see a total eclipse. You could wait hundreds of years to see two in the same place.

What is a solar eclipse?

A solar eclipse occurs when the Moon passes between the Sun and the Earth. By doing this, the Moon stops much of the Sun's light from reaching the Earth. The resulting shadow means that, temporarily, day turns to night in certain places.

The Sun has been covered by the Moon.

People at the centre of the Moon's shadow experience a total solar eclipse.

